

HEURISTIC EVALUATION

Appointments Module

Evaluated against Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
ServCraft · UX Review · 2025

OVERVIEW

This report presents findings from a heuristic evaluation of the Appointments module. Six usability issues were identified by assessing the interface against Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics. Each issue is rated by severity and paired with a concrete recommendation.

The evaluation covered the full appointment scheduling workflow from page load through appointment creation, including search, filter, and configuration interactions.

SEVERITY SCALE

High	Critical failure. Users are blocked, misled, or an irreversible action occurs without warning. Fix immediately.
Medium	Significant friction that degrades the experience for a range of users. Address in the near term.
Low	Minor inconvenience with a clear workaround. Address as time permits.

Summary of Findings

#	Issue	Heuristic	Severity	Status
#1	No immediate appointment context	H1: Visibility of System Status	High	Open
#2	Search & filter affects both panels simultaneously	H3: User Control & Freedom	High	Open
#3	Settings drawer lacks	H8: Aesthetic &	Medium	Open

#	Issue	Heuristic	Severity	Status
	hierarchy and save feedback	Minimalist Design		
#4	Appointment blocks shrink and become unreadable at scale	H7: Flexibility & Efficiency of Use	Medium	Open
#5	Status colours have insufficient contrast	H4: Consistency & Standards	Medium	Open
#6	Automatic email sent to customer without consent	H5: Error Prevention	High	Open

Detailed Findings

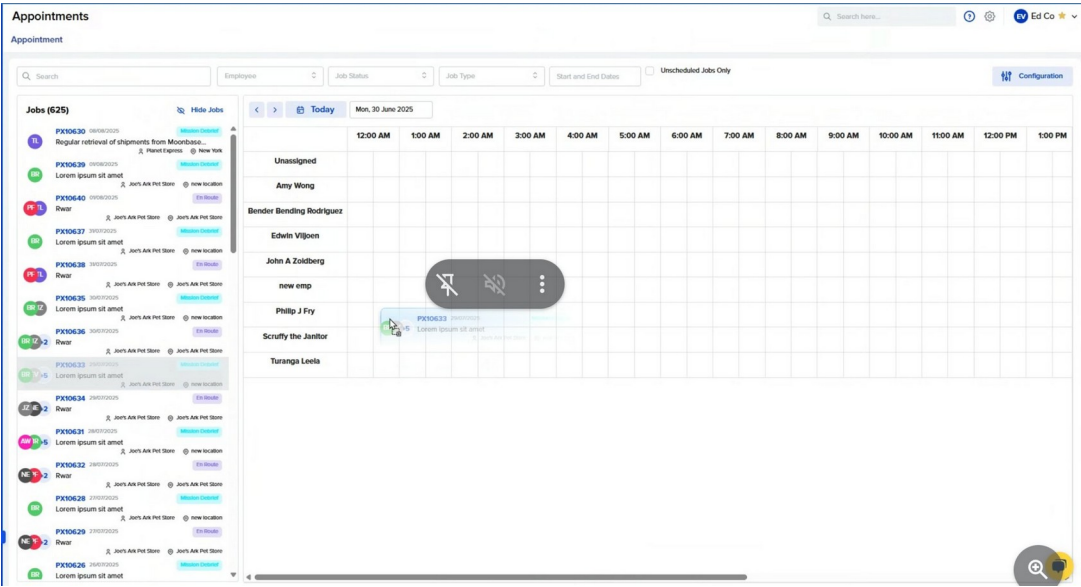
#1 No immediate appointment context

Heuristic	H1 Visibility of System Status
Severity	High
Observation	Users land on the Appointments page seeing only a jobs list and a scheduler with no appointment data visible. There is no empty state, onboarding cue, or any feedback to orient them.
Why it violates	The system fails to communicate its current state. Users cannot tell whether they have any appointments or what they are supposed to do next directly violating the principle that the system should always keep users informed through timely, appropriate feedback.
Recommendation	Show an informative empty state or a summary panel with upcoming and recent appointments on page load. Add a contextual prompt that explains the workflow (e.g. "Drag a job onto the scheduler to create an appointment").

#2 Search & filter affects both panels simultaneously

Heuristic	H3 User Control & Freedom
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Severity	High
Observation	When a user searches or filters, both the jobs list and the scheduler update at the same time. Users trying to find a job to schedule lose full visibility of the scheduler, breaking the intended drag-and-drop workflow.
Why it violates	Users cannot achieve their goal (find a job, then schedule it) because the interface removes the context they need the scheduler while they are searching. There is no way to scope the action, stripping the user of control over the interface state.
Recommendation	Decouple search scope: provide independent search controls for the jobs list and the scheduler, or add a toggle so users can explicitly choose which panel is affected by a search.

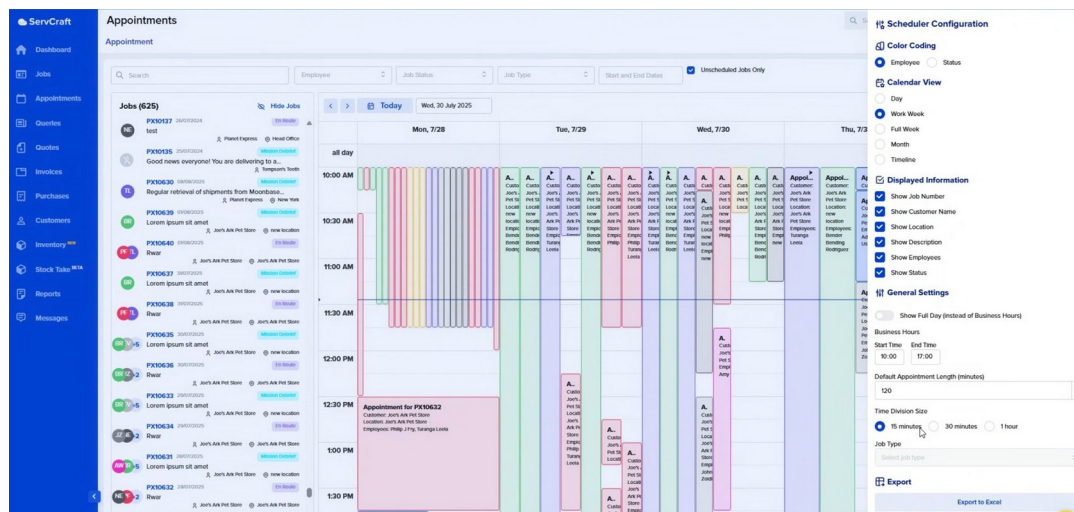


The original Appointments page: users see a jobs list and blank scheduler with no appointment context or guidance.

#3 Settings drawer lacks hierarchy and save feedback

Heuristic	H8 Aesthetic & Minimalist Design + H1 Visibility of System Status
Severity	Medium
Observation	The configuration panel presents a large number of options with no clear grouping, inconsistent controls, and no confirmation that settings have been saved.

Why it violates	Presenting too many undifferentiated options overwhelms users (minimalist design). The absence of save confirmation leaves users uncertain whether their changes have been applied (visibility of system status).
Recommendation	Group settings into clearly labelled sections with visual separators. Use progressive disclosure (collapsible groups) to reduce cognitive load. Add explicit save/cancel actions with a success notification or auto-save indicator.



The original Scheduler Configuration drawer: an undifferentiated list of controls with no grouping, hierarchy, or save confirmation.

#4 Appointment blocks shrink and become unreadable at scale

Heuristic	H7 Flexibility & Efficiency of Use
Severity	Medium
Observation	Appointments are displayed side-by-side horizontally. As the number of appointments increases, each block becomes narrower and harder to read, degrading usability for busy calendars.
Why it violates	The layout does not scale to realistic workloads. Power users managing many appointments are penalised rather than supported, contrary to the principle that the system should serve a range of users efficiently.
Recommendation	Introduce overflow handling such as a stacked view, a "+N more" popover, or an agenda/list view option for high-volume days.

#5 Status colours have insufficient contrast

Heuristic	H4 Consistency & Standards
Severity	Medium
Observation	The colours used to represent appointment statuses do not meet accessibility contrast requirements, making it difficult to distinguish statuses at a glance particularly for users with colour vision deficiencies.
Why it violates	Low-contrast colours make the status system unreliable as a communication tool, creating accessibility barriers and inconsistency in how the real-world state of appointments is conveyed.
Recommendation	Audit all status colours against WCAG AA ratios (minimum 4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for UI components). Supplement colour with an icon or text label so the system does not rely on colour alone.

#6 Automatic email sent to customer without consent

Heuristic	H5 Error Prevention + H3 User Control & Freedom
Severity	High
Observation	When a user creates an appointment, an email is automatically sent to the customer with no prior warning, confirmation prompt, or opt-out mechanism.
Why it violates	This is a critical error prevention failure: users cannot review or prevent an irreversible action sending an external communication before it occurs. It also removes control over customer-facing messaging, which can cause real-world harm and erode trust.
Recommendation	Add a confirmation step before saving an appointment that clearly states an email will be sent and offers an option to suppress it. Alternatively, treat email notification as an explicit opt-in action, fully separate from appointment creation.

Appendix: Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics

The following framework was used as the basis for this evaluation.

1 Visibility of System Status

Designs should *keep users informed* about what is going on, through appropriate, timely feedback.



Interactive mall maps have to show people where they currently are, to help them understand where to go next.

2 Match between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts *familiar to the user*, rather than internal jargon.



Users can quickly understand which stovetop control maps to each heating element.

5 Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully *prevent problems* from occurring in the first place.



Guard rails on curvy mountain roads prevent drivers from falling off cliffs.

8 Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information which is irrelevant. Every extra unit of information in an interface *competes* with the relevant units of information.



A minimalist three-legged stool is still a place to sit.

NN/g

Nielsen Norman Group

Jakob's Ten Usability Heuristics

3 User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They *need a clearly marked "emergency exit"* to leave the unwanted action.



Just like physical spaces, digital spaces need quick "emergency" exits too.

6 Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. Avoid making users remember information.



People are likely to correctly answer "Is Lisbon the capital of Portugal?".

9 Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.



Wrong-way signs on the road remind drivers that they are heading in the wrong direction.

4 Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. *Follow platform conventions.*



Check-in counters are usually located at the front of hotels, which meets expectations.

7 Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — *may speed up the interaction* for the expert user.



Regular routes are listed on maps, but locals with more knowledge of the area can take shortcuts.

10 Help and Documentation

It's best if the design *doesn't need* any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users complete their tasks.



Information kiosks at airports are easily recognizable and solve customers' problems in context and immediately.

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Based on Nielsen's ten heuristics. Updated by Scott Klemmer and Janaki Kumar.

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